League Rules as of September 30th, 2014

A. SCORE SHEETS
   1. Completed score sheets are due no later than Friday close of business – the sooner the better.
      a. First time late turning in score sheet results in warning
      b. Each successive time late turning in score sheet results in 2 points deducted from standings
   2. During each match you may mark the winner with either a "W" or an "8" – the "8" represents the shooter made his 7 balls plus the 8-ball.
   3. **The WINNER of each game earns 8 points no matter how they win**
   4. **The loser of each game earns 7 minus the number of his balls left on the table.**
   5. **If you scratch on the 8 ball while legally attempting to pocket the 8 ball you have earned 7 points for that loss. Your opponent earns 8 points.**
   6. **If you knock the 8 ball in early, you receive 7 minus the number of your balls left on the table; count any balls that were pocketed on that shot as balls made. The winner of this match earns 8 points.**
   7. No-Shows / Forfeits
      a. Offending team
         i. -3 points for the offending team for that match
         ii. Write in the player who would have shot that match - if he/she is not already on your roster they will be added to one of your open slots permanently
      b. Non-Offending team
         i. +3 points for the non-offending team for that match
         ii. Write in the player who was present and would have shot that match
      c. The match win/loss will not count toward individual statistics
      d. Both teams are responsible to turn in $25.00 for the night (see B.1)
      e. If both teams are short players for a match both teams score -3 points for that match.

B. MONEY COLLECTION / FEES
   1. **Each team will turn in $25.00 per night.**
   2. Teams are responsible for any money short of $25.00 in the event they are unable to field 5 shooters for the match.

C. PAYOUTS
   1. $5.00 will be awarded to players who make the 8-ball on the break without scratching the cue ball.
   2. $5.00 will be awarded to players who break, and then run out all of their balls plus the 8-ball in one turn.

D. HANDICAPS
   1. Unknown new players:
      a. All MEN will start as a 4 and use the race chart to determine their race (unless 2 or 3 below).
      b. All WOMEN will start as a 3 and use the race chart to determine their race (unless 2 or 3 below).
   2. Known new players: Use an agreed upon (both captains) rating to start the new KNOWN player out as and use the race chart to determine their race. Make sure you give them a handicap that is comparable to other players in the league of their caliber.
   3. Other league ratings: contact Shawn at 443.859.1203 to get Tuesday night conversion.

E. EQUIPMENT

1. Any regulation cue-stick above 40" is legal – you may not shoot with only a shaft if using a two-piece cue (remember, breaking the cue down is automatic forfeit).
2. Jump, and Jump-Break, cues are legal and cues with removable butts are legal.
3. Breaking your shooting cue down during a game is loss of game.
4. A player may switch shafts if a shaft/tip is determined to be defective, damaged, or broken
5. Purposely breaking, or destroying a cue, will result in loss of match for offending player

ALL FOULS ARE BALL-IN-HAND

F. TIMEOUTS

1. Shooters rated 4, 3, 2, and 1 get TWO timeouts per game
2. Shooters rated 5, 6, 7, and 8 only can take ONE timeout per game.
3. Miscellaneous
    a. Anyone on the team can call a timeout.
    b. EACH team must use the **SAME COACH** for the duration of a match.
    c. THE PLAYER SHOOTING MUST PLACE THE CUE BALL ON THE TABLE HIMSELF/HERSELF.
    d. DO NOT MARK THE TABLE with the chalk, coins, by licking, etc. This is a FOUL.
    e. Placing chalk or other objects on rails for aiming purposes is not allowed either; also a FOUL.
    f. Discussing a rule - The shooter should inform both captains before discussing a rule to avoid disputes. Players are allowed to inquire about rules without using a timeout.
    g. Timeouts will last about 1 minute from when the opposing team initially begins discussing the shot at hand.
    h. If a timeout is taking longer than 1 minute, the non-shooting player may announce that his opponent is now "on the clock".
    i. You have one additional minute if placed "on the clock". Enforcing team must give a 10-second warning to shooter who is "on the clock" when he has only 10 seconds left in clocked-minute.
    j. Failure to break-up the timeout after additional "clocked" minute expires is a FOUL if the opposing team wants to enforce the rule.
    k. This rule (3.g. through 3.j.) **SHOULD NOT BE ABUSED** – You may enforce this rule strictly as it is a rule but please keep in mind this rule was put in place as a defense for those who are routinely abusing the length of their timeouts.

    l. *While in timeout, only one person (the coach) may approach the shooter and discuss the current shot with that shooter. The coach may go back to discuss the shot with the other players on the team but ONLY the coach may directly talk to the shooter and give direct advice to the shooter. The shooter should stand away from any group conversations. The team must not communicate with the shooter from their positions.

    ***The opposing team will initially warn the offending team of violations with respect to the rules marked with an asterisk above. Successive warnings may result in further warnings by the opposing team but the opposing team may call a foul if they desire to do so.

G. GAME PLAY

1. **Shooters rated 3, 2, or 1 DO NOT have to call any pockets except for when they are shooting the 8-ball and when table is still open**. (see rule 17, iv. for open table rules)
2. 4s and up must call a pocket (call pocket only – do not have to call banks, kisses, caroms, etc.).
3. Anyone can inform the shooter that a foul has occurred and that the shooter has ball-in-hand.
4. Jumping / masse shots are ALLOWED.
5. Touching any ball (other than cue ball) with hand, stick, or clothes <u>while shooter has ball-in-hand</u>: There is NO FOUL if it is the first time this has occurred during the MATCH. The shooter must indicate to his opponent that he has moved/touched a ball. The opponent then has the option to restore the balls to where they were or let the table lay as is.
    a. If the shooter <u>does not</u> indicate he has touched the balls and continues to shoot his opponent may issue a warning.
    b. Subsequent violations result in a FOUL and the incoming shooter will play the table as it lays (do not restore balls to their previous positions).
6. **Pushing through the cue ball IS ALLOWED at all times**. Pushing through occurs when the cue ball is frozen or so close to the object ball that it would be impossible for the shooter to shoot the shot without double-hitting the cue ball.
7. It is a FOUL if a cue ball is jumped into the air and touches an object OTHER THAN
    a. a ball of the shooter's group of balls (laying on the playing surface)
    b. a cushion,
    c. or the top of a cushion's rail
    d. In other words if the cue ball would touch a light, a light's chain, a cue's shaft, a piece of chalk, a player, etc..
8. While shooting the 8-ball the following is a loss of game
    a. A scratch
    b. Jumping cue ball off the table and onto another surface other than the table cloth you are playing on, the rails on the table you are playing on, or the top of the rail on the table you are playing on. It is not a FOUL if the cue ball leaves the table and rolls onto or lands on the top of a cushion's rail and then returns back to the table without touching any other objects such as hands, cues, chalk, clothing, etc.
9. It is a FOUL to jump balls off the table.
    a. 8-ball jumped off table is a loss of game.
    b. Other balls jumped off the table GET POCKETED.
10. It is not the offending player's responsibility to declare he has fouled. It is the responsibility of his opponent to call the foul.

11. Shots that may potentially cause disputes;
    a. If a shot is attempted that may potentially cause a dispute PLEASE have both captains watch the shot.
    b. All balls frozen on rails must be declared frozen by the shooter's opponent before the shooter shoots his next shot.
    c. If a shot occurs where it was too close to tell which group of balls the cue ball made contact with first – the shooter gets the benefit of the doubt.
12. DO NOT TOUCH the cue ball until your opponent acknowledges he has fouled. All disputes will be settled by both team captains. If agreement cannot be reached a coin-flip will determine the outcome.
13. If you have ball-in-hand, you may move the cue ball around with ANY part of your cue, including the tip, ferrule, shaft, or butt AS LONG as you are not making any intent at stroking the cue ball. If you make any STROKE on the cue ball a shot has occurred.

14. Moving ball FOULS are:
    a. Touching the cue ball if it is still spinning.
    b. Shooting the cue ball if it is still spinning.
    c. Touching the cue ball if other balls are still moving.
    d. Touching an object ball if the cue ball is still moving.
    e. Touching an object ball if other object balls are still moving.

15. Racking
    a. <u>Winner has the option to rack his own rack of balls.</u>
    b. 8-ball must be the middle ball in third row back from head-ball.
    c. Rack placed on spot or as close as possible if cloth does not allow for a good rack when head ball is placed on spot.
16. Breaks
    a. Lag or flip coin to decide the first game's break.
    b. The winner of the previous game will break the next rack.
    c. Each player is afforded 1 miscue per match on the break. All successive miscues in same match will be loss of break attempt (opponent has option to defer the break back to the offending shooter).
    d. There are no illegal breaks in this league – play rack as it lays.
    e. Making the 8-ball on the break is a WIN.
    f. Making the 8-ball on the break and scratching is a LOSS.
17. Shot immediately following the break shot;
    a. IF STARTING OUT ON A FOULED TABLE
        i. Table is still open.
        ii. Incoming player has ball-in-hand behind the line.
        iii. Must make contact with a rail or ball in front of the line before any balls behind the line are contacted.
        iv. Balls jumped off the table on break IS A FOUL
            a. Ball-in-hand behind the line for opponent
            b. Play table as it lays (do not spot balls)
            c. ALL BALLS JUMPED OFF TABLE <u>ON BREAK</u> GET POCKETED.
    b. IF STARTING OUT ON A SUCCESFULLY BROKEN TABLE
        i. Table is still open following the break
        ii. May legally
            a. shoot a stripe into a solid.
            b. shoot a solid into a stripe.
            c. Shooters MAY NOT strike the 8-ball first with cue ball to pocket balls.
        iii. Table remains open until one player legally pockets a ball.
        iv. 2s and 3s MUST CALL THEIR SHOT IF TABLE IS STILL OPEN.
18. Stalemate Games: When neither player "wants" or "can" make use of ball-in-hand, then the balls are re-racked and the original breaker will break the new rack.

19. **SHOT CLOCK:** All shooters will have 1 minute to shoot their shots once they address the table on their turn. Once 1 minute expires the opposing team my let the shooter know they have 1 additional minute to shoot their current shot. IF THE second minute expires and the player still has not taken their shot;
    i. First offense: Warning
    ii. Second offense (and subsequent): Foul – loss of turn and ball-in-hand for opponent
20. **<u>ABSOLUTELY NO SMOKING DURING MATCHES</u>** for the two players involved in the current match.

H. STANDARD FOULS (not all-inclusive) THERE IS NO 3-FOUL RULE (see G.18 for "stalemate games)

1. Cue ball scratch or cue ball off of the legal playing surface.
2. Hit wrong ball first – the first ball contacted by the cue ball on each shot when the table is not “open” must belong to the shooter’s group.
3. A ball does not travel to rail after contact on shots where no ball is pocketed
    a. If object ball is frozen initially it must travel to a rail other than the rail it is frozen to for it to be considered to have contacted another rail.
    b. The table has four rails – the long rails ARE NOT separate rails on each side of the side pocket; it is still the same rail.
4. Not having at least one foot on the floor
5. Ball driven off table
6. Touched cue ball when a player does not have ball-in-hand
7. Double-hitting the cue ball (however pushing is allowed)
8. Touching cue ball while it’s in the air with any object or body part
9. Touching the cue ball while balls are still in motion
10. Touching balls with cue ball when you have ball-in-hand (1 warning per match)
11. Playing out of turn

I. CONTACT

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